

Advocating for students' stipend increase

Presentation highlights **key findings** from a student cost of living survey, aiming at achieving increased stipends across departments in the College of Medicine.

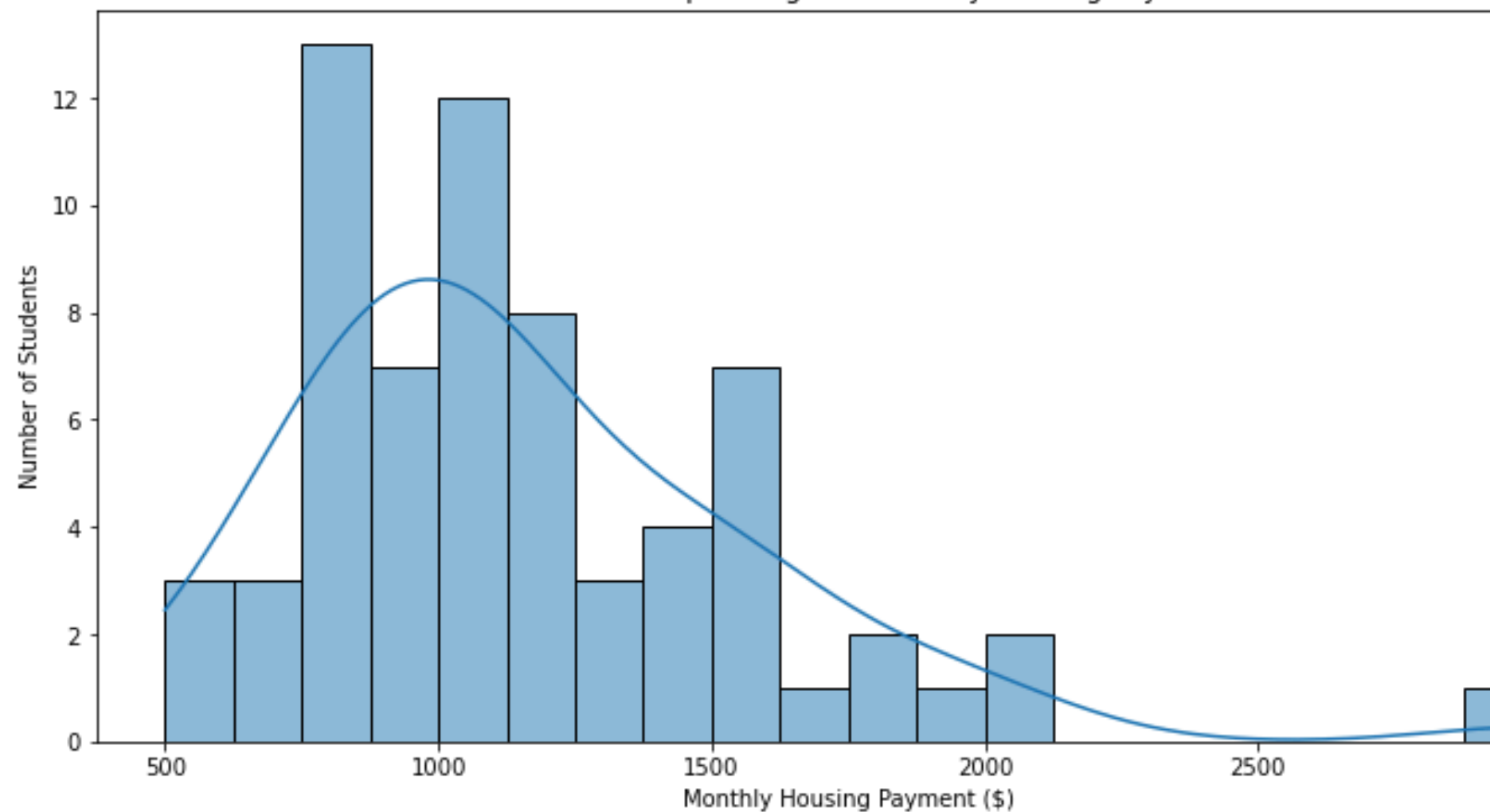
Data Collection

91 students got to take part in a google forms survey between 2025/08/20 11:02:56 AM AST - 2025/09/05 10:41:37 AM AST , with an aim of getting a glimpse into students' cost of living.

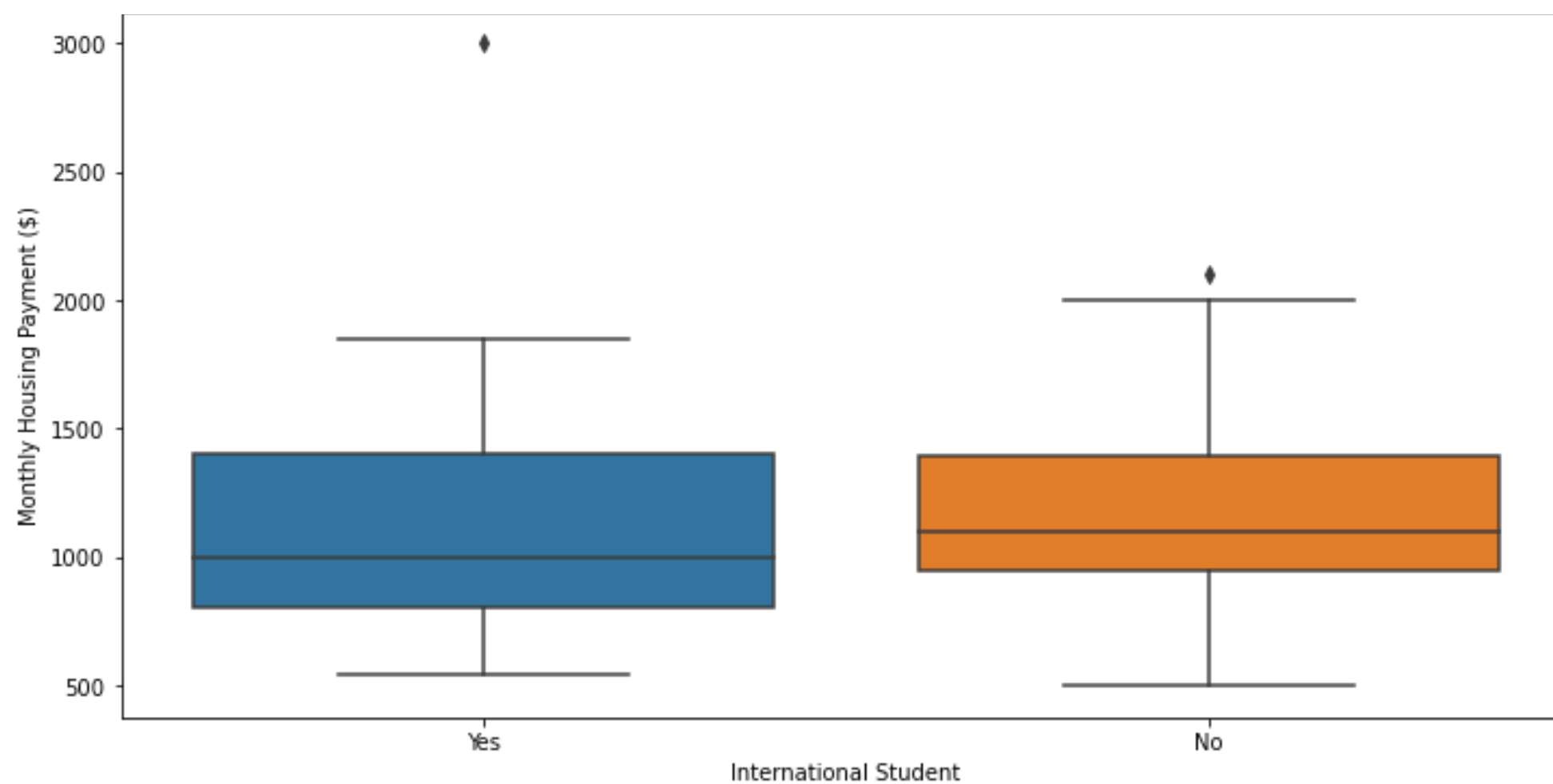
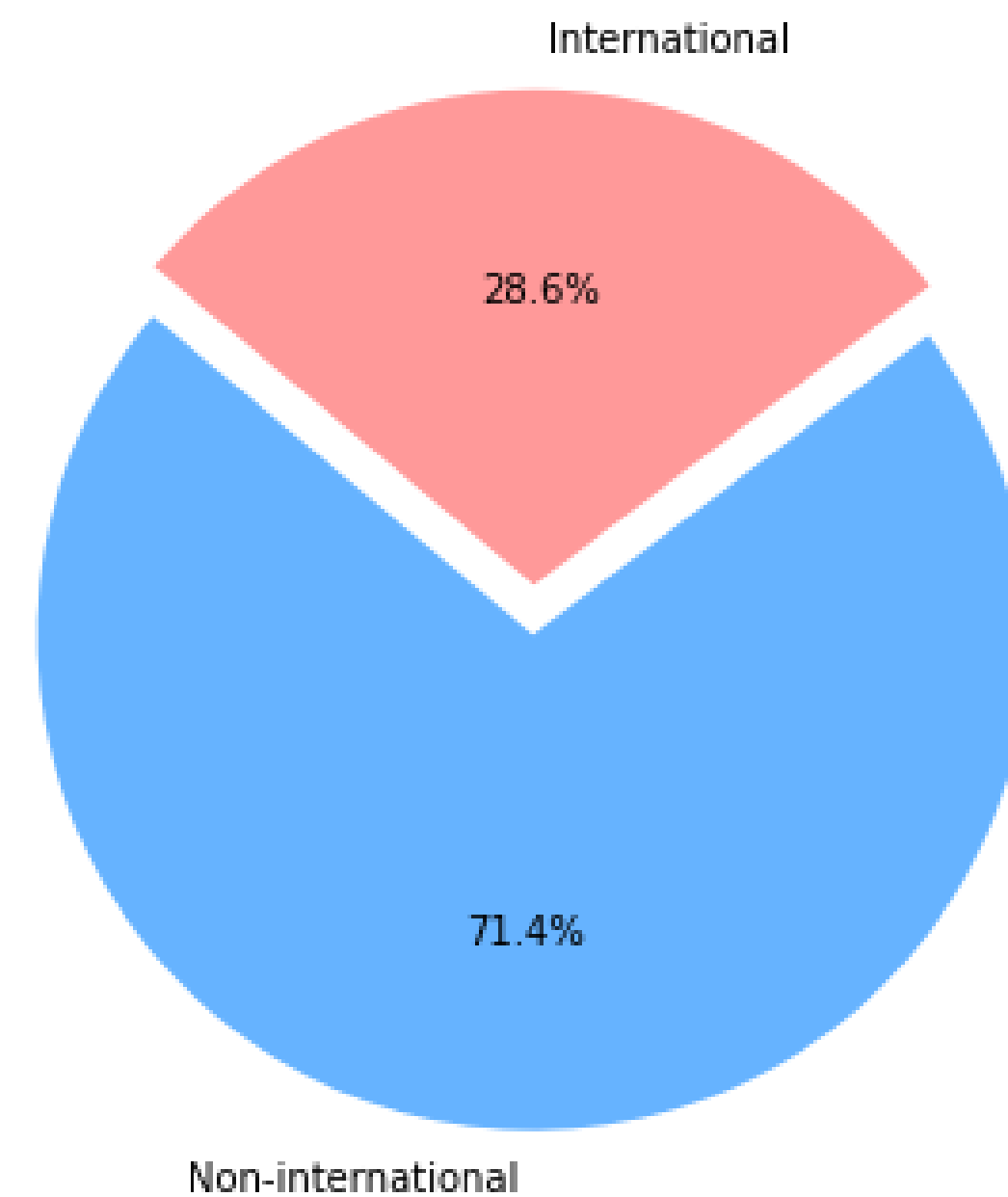
Key features:

1. **Individual_monthly housing payment during the previous year (Base cost; no utilities).**
2. **Individual monthly housing payment for the upcoming year (Base Cost; no utilities).**
3. **Trade-offs made by students to meet living expenses.**
4. **Average monthly (not weekly) expenditure on groceries and dining out.**

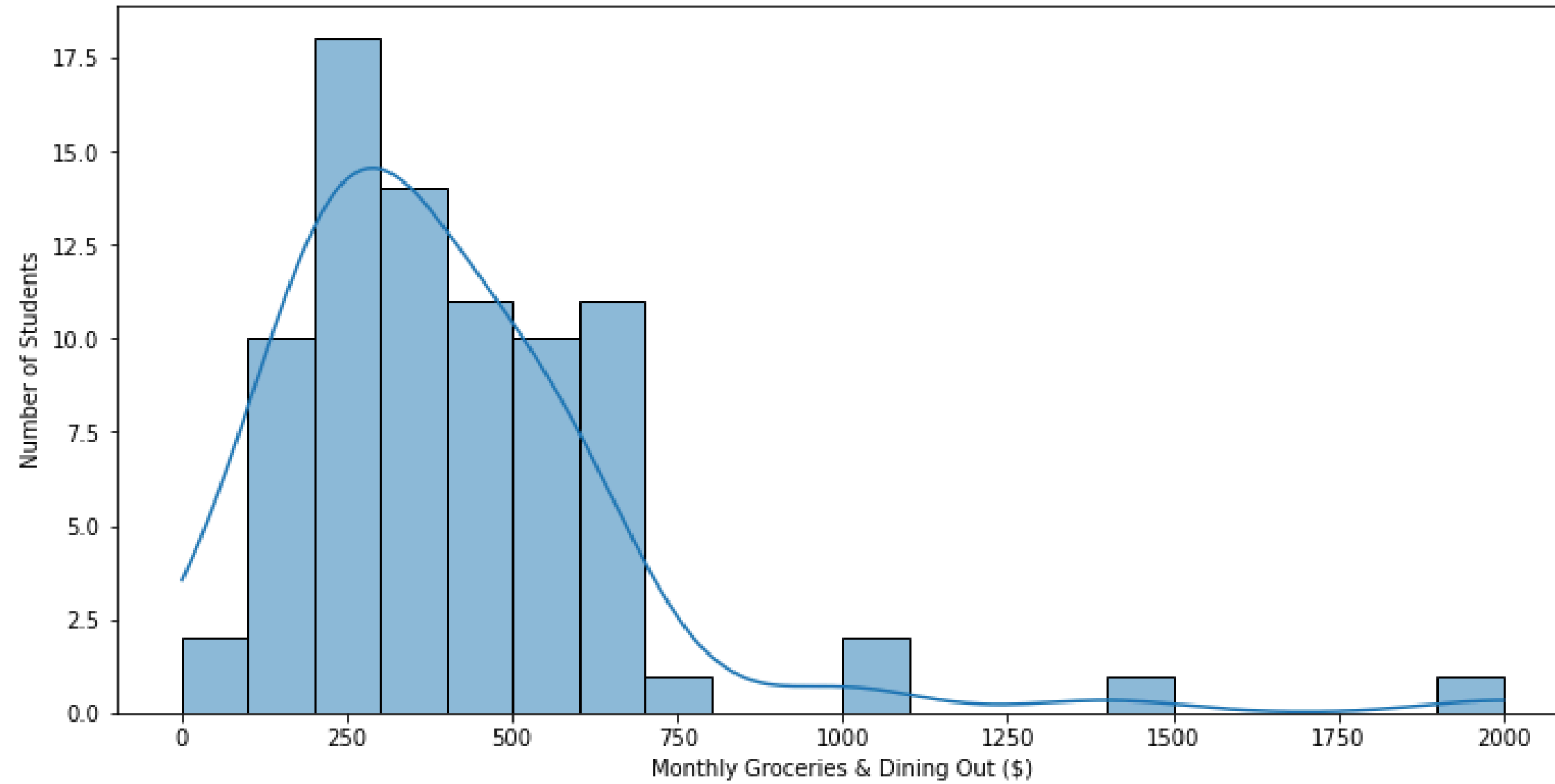
Distribution of Upcoming Year Monthly Housing Payment



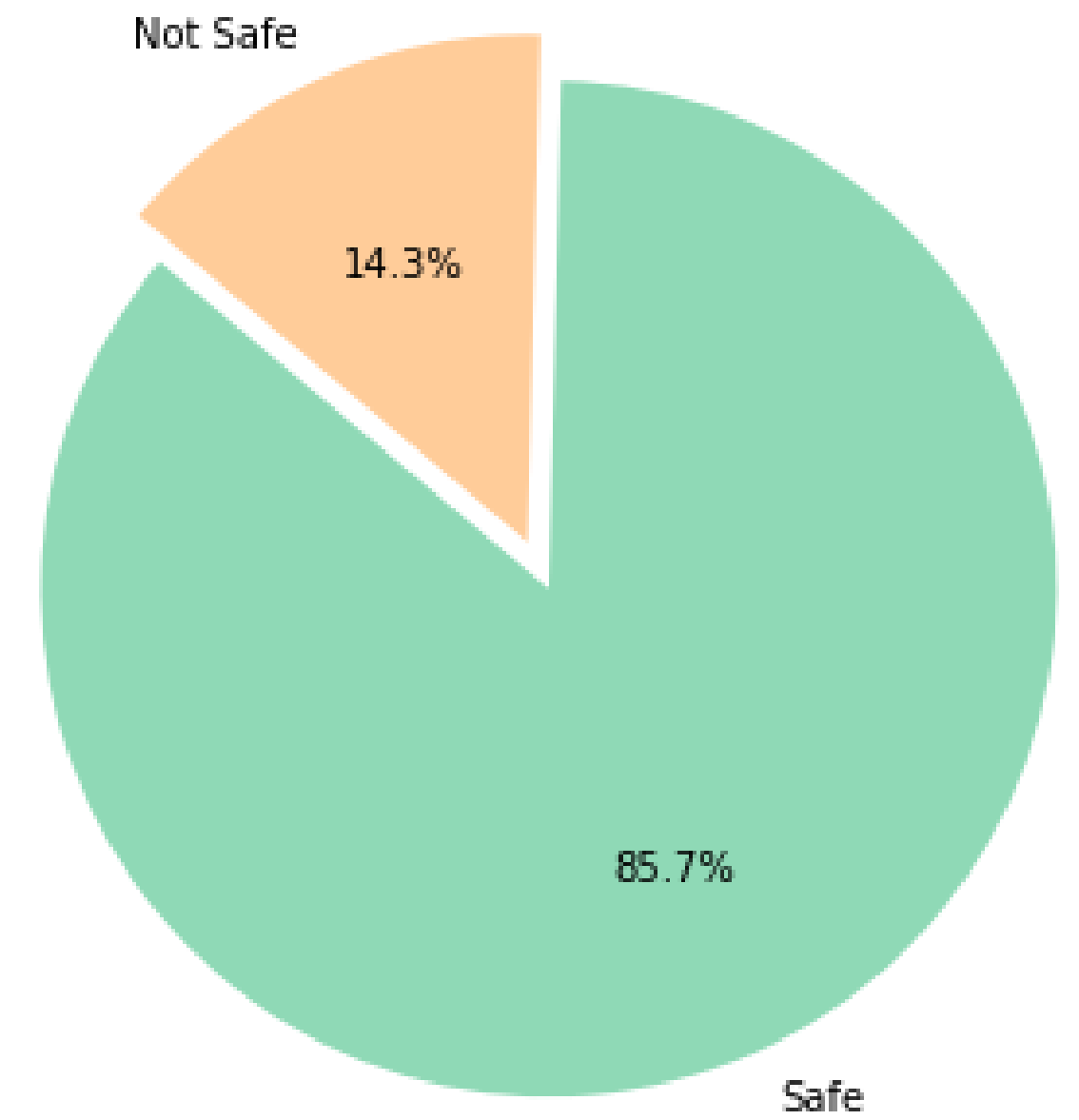
International vs Non-international Students



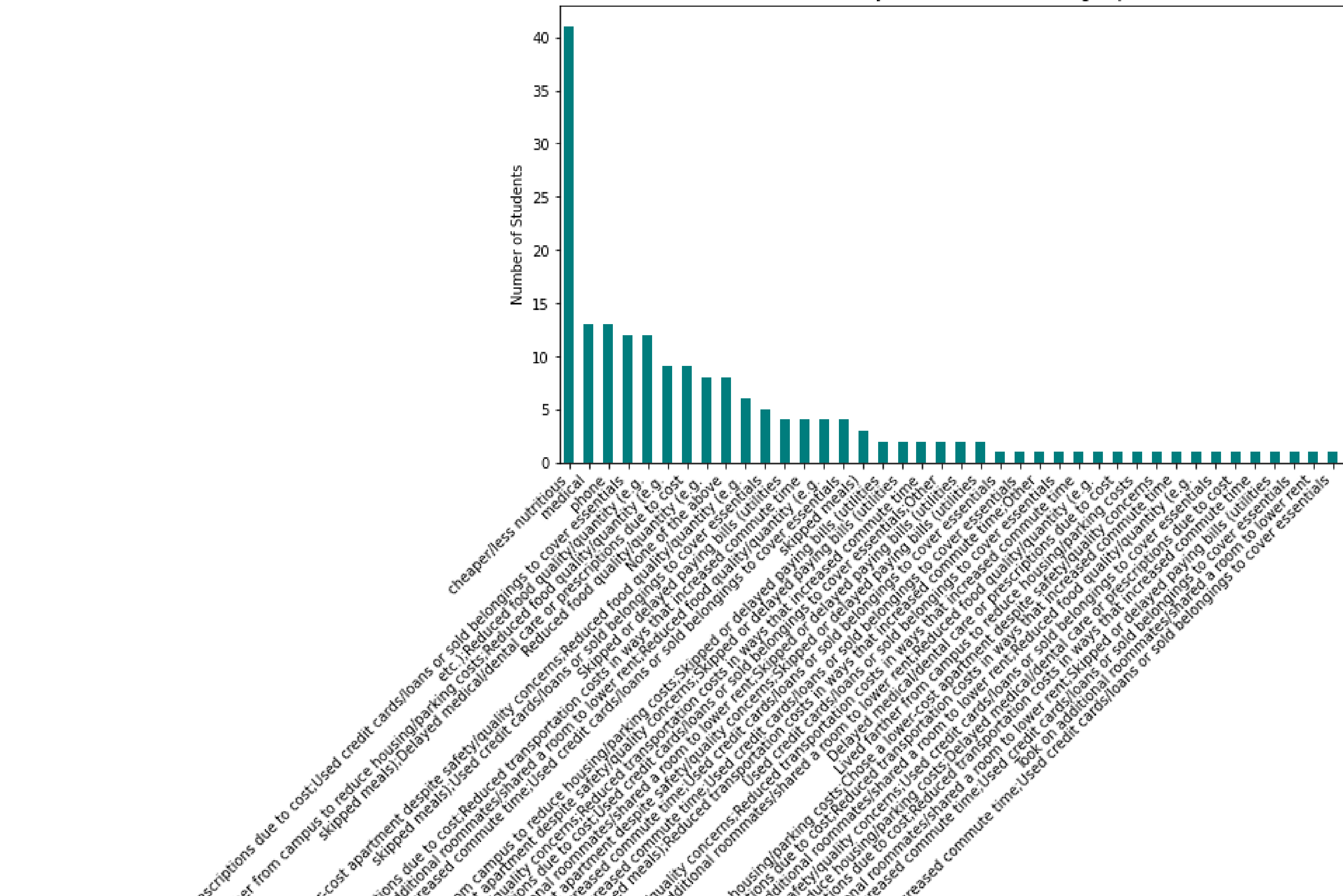
Distribution of Monthly Groceries & Dining Out Expenditure



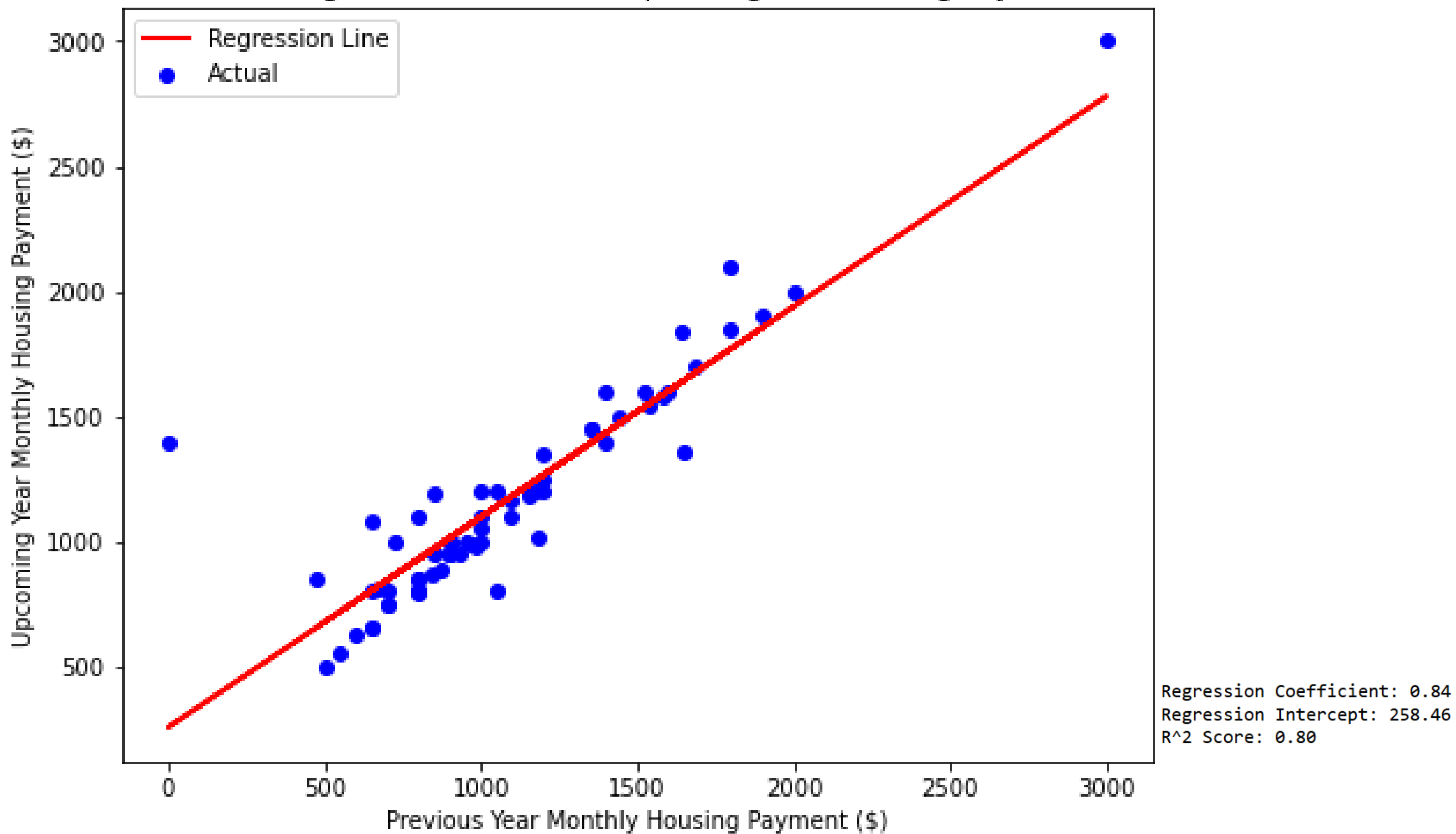
Perceived Neighborhood Safety



Trade-offs Made by Students to Meet Living Expenses



Linear Regression: Previous vs Upcoming Year Housing Payment



Recommendations:

1. Increase housing stipends : Median housing costs are high and rising. Consider raising the base stipend to match the median rent plus utilities. Upcoming year monthly housing rent is also predicted to increase based on our Regression model
2. Targeted support for international students : International students may face higher housing costs and fewer funding options. Provide additional grants or subsidies.
3. Food security programs : Some students report high monthly food expenses, preferring to go for cheaper,less nutritious foods. Implement or expand food assistance or subsidies programs.
4. Transportation subsidies : Offer discounted transit passes or parking subsidies, as commuting costs vary widely.
5. Emergency funds : Create flexible emergency funding for students facing unexpected expenses (health, dependents, etc.).